

Observing WUL Tips and Tricks

Start of Game

Coin Flip = visiting team's captain/coach makes the call for Heads / Tails.

- Show them the coin and which side is "Heads" and which is "Tails".

Winner chooses either (a) Pull Q1 & Q3 -or- Pull Q2 & Q4 or (b) Which side to start on for the first 2 Q's. Other team gets to choose the other option.

Overall Game Timing

There are 4 Quarters, each 12 minutes. There are 2 min after Q1 and Q3. There is a 10 min halftime after Q2. If there is an OT, there are 5 min between Q4 and OT.

The clock is running and teams score as many points as they can. Regulation time clock stops:

- Between every point
- All Injury Timeouts

In the last 2 minutes of every Quarter, time clock also stops:

- For every call
- When the disc becomes out of bounds (ex. Rolls across the sideline line out of bounds, hits the ground out of bounds, or is caught by an out of bounds person)
- When a disc turns over, stays in bounds but comes to rest in the end zone
- When the pull becomes out of bounds (ex. rolls across the line out of bounds, hits the ground out of bounds, or is caught by an out of bounds person)

Start of Quarter / Between Points

Teams have up to 60 seconds at the beginning of every quarter and between every point. This looks like:

- At 20 seconds, Receiving Team (RT) will get a 20 second warning.
- At 40 seconds, RT coaches off the field and the 7 from RT should give readiness
- Also at 40 seconds or once RT signals readiness, Pulling Team (PT) will get a 20 second warning.
- At 60 seconds or 20 seconds after RT signals readiness, PT should pull.

This can be a tight turnaround after a score to record who scored, run back and give the RT 20 second warning all within 20 seconds, especially in a 2 observer system. In a 4 observer system, there are enough observers that it is easier. Either way, this makes USAU between point timing so much easier.

Any egregious violations of the between-point timing result in a Time Violation. No warning, straight to penalty:

- Against RT = start the point at reverse brick
- Against PT = start the point at midfield
- Either way, the offense has 20 seconds from the signaled violation to get the disc into the appropriate spot on the field while the defense gets into position to check the disc into play. That is 20 sec total, NOT 20 sec then another 20 sec.

Offsides / False Start

No warnings – straight to penalties. False start = reverse brick. Offsides (that's accepted by offense) = midfield. Timing of penalties is exactly the same as Time Violation penalties.

Timeouts

These are 60 seconds. However, there are some very different aspects from USAU:

- If taken during a point, after 60 seconds, offense gets 20 sec to set, then defense gets 20 sec to check the disc in.
 - That's 1min 40sec total for time out during a point.
- Between points, normal between-point timing resumes after 60 sec is up.
- 2 timeouts per half.

TO fun facts:

- During a point, the player with possession or coaches on the sideline may call TO (usually by blowing an eWhistle or throwing a flag if an eWhistle is not available).
- Any and all players may be substituted during a TO.
- Stall resets to 1.
- TO's may only be taken if there is time on the clock. If the time has run out and a TO is attempted, it is considered a turnover and that Quarter ends.
- If a TO is attempted with time on the clock but that team has no TO's left, then add 3 to the last number said during the stall:
 - If it is 6 or less, resume play at that stall count. If it is 7 or greater, it is a turnover.
- Between points, TO's may only be called by coaches.

Stall

The stall is 7. If there is a contested stall, disc comes back in at 5.

Restarting Stall after a call: Generally, stalls come in similarly to USAU - last count plus 1. For most situations where the disc would normally come in at "no higher than 6" in USAU, that is 4 in WUL (for contested fouls/violations). For retracted offensive calls or uncontested/upheld offensive fouls, the stall comes in at no higher than 6. For retracted defensive calls, the stall restarts at 1.

However, picks are a little different in WUL. Contested and uncontested picks are treated differently. Contested = the stall comes in at no higher than 4. Uncontested = the stall comes in at no higher than 6

End of Quarters

Quarters end on a score or turnover. If a team has possession when the horn blows, they play until there is a turnover or a score.

Fouls / Picks

Players have 15 seconds to come to a resolution or it will be treated as contested.

Players must be within 2 yards (~6 ft) to call a pick.

Instant Referral

Observers can instantly refer 4 calls: **travels**, **picks**, **double teams**, and **stalls**. Restarting play:

- Travel - if upheld, player fixes the travel (disc comes back if thrown) and play restarts with a Pre-Check.
 - If overruled, play resumes without a Pre-Check.
- Picks - if upheld or observer can make no instant referral, there is a Pre-Check.
 - If overruled, play resumes without a Pre-Check.
- Double Teams - if upheld, player(s) fix the double team, and there is a Pre-Check.
 - If overruled, play resumes without a Pre-Check.
- Stalls - there is NO pre-check for both upheld and overruled.
 - However, if observer cannot make a ruling, it remains contested and there is a pre-check.

Pre-Check

In WUL, there is a Pre Check – a 4 second period where players can move before the disc is checked in. This is to avoid the disc from coming into play from a standstill. It is executed by the observer:

- The thrower has possession of the disc, whatever pause has been resolved, and the observer confirms the disc will be coming in on a Pre-Check.
- Observer then announces “4, 3, 2, 1, disc in”. The thrower cannot fake/pivot, but the remaining 13 players may move.
- While the observer says “disc in”, the disc can be checked in either by offensive self-check or defensive check, and the mark can initiate a stall count.

Fun Facts about Pre-Check:

- If the thrower fakes/pivots/gets into a throwing position, play stops and pre-check is restarted.
 - If the thrower infracts a 2nd time, it is a turnover.
- The observer doing the pre-check should keep their arm in the air until they say “Disc In”.
- Roughly, if a team finds themselves in a stoppage and are capable of “setting up a play” and/or the disc is immediately “in play”, there is no pre-check. Example:
 - After timeouts, teams can “set up” how they choose, so there is no pre-check.
 - However, after a foul, teams stop and do not get an option to set up how they want after resolution = pre-check.
 - Similarly, injury timeout but no one has possession, there is no stall on a player with the disc so players have time to adjust on-field spacing before the disc is picked up and “in play”.

There is a cheat sheet at the end of this document to help you remember what has a Pre-Check.

Overtime

Since this is not common, there is a “cheat sheet” at the end of this document for you to print out and review in the 5min between Q4 and OT.

OT 1 - 4 min time clock. A new coin flip & the home team shall make the call. The winning team picks whether they shall receive or pull, or the end zone they wish to defend. The other team gets the remaining choice.

During the first 2 minutes, the clock stops like normal regulation time. During the last 2 minutes, the clock shall stop like the final 2 minutes of regulation. If the disc is in the air when time expires, the play shall continue until the result of the throw is determined. No subsequent throw shall be permitted.

If the game is still tied at the end of OT 1, teams go to OT 2. There are 2 min between OT 1 and OT2.

OT 2 - sudden death. The teams switch the endzone position (so whoever pulled in OT1 now receives in OT 2) based on how play was initiated in the OT 1. The first team to score shall end the game.

Each team is given one timeout per Overtime.

Cheat Sheets

Use Pre-Check	Do NOT Use Pre-Check
• All Fouls & Violations • Uncontested & observer upheld Picks calls (defender to re-establish position during pre-stall) • Picks that are contested and the observer cannot make an instant referral call • Stalls that are contested and the observer cannot make instant referral call • Injury substitutions while a team is in possession of the disc and a pre-stall has not commenced	• Timeouts • Observer overruled calls on Travels, Double Teams, and Pick calls • Uncontested, observer overruled, or upheld Stall calls • Injury substitution where there is no possession of the disc
Overtime 1	Overtime 2
• 4 min game clock • New flip for Side or Offense/Defense • Normal clock stoppage during first 2 min • Last 2 min stoppage during last 2 min • OT ends when it ends, not when possession ends. If disc is in the air, result of the throw stands and OT ends • 1 Time Out for both teams.	• Sudden Death • Reverse of what was chosen in OT 1 starts. • First team to score wins. • 1 Time Out for both teams. ◦ So if 2 OT's, that is 1 TO per OT.

How to resume stall			
Restart at "1"	+1, no more than "4"	Comes in at "5"	+1, no more than "6"
• Uncontested Def. Foul • Retracted Def. Call • Contact (no play stoppage)	• Contested Pick • Contested Foul/Violation • Offsetting Calls	• Contested Stall (that observer cannot instantly refer)	• Uncontested Pick • Uncontested Off. Foul • Retracted Off. Call

Q1		PULLING	Q2		RECEIVING
RECEIVING			PULLING		
Q3		RECEIVING	Q4		PULLING
PULLING			RECEIVING		

Instant Referrals
Travel Pick Double Team Stall

Color OBSERVER SCORE CARD Color													
☐ HOME VISITOR ☐						☐ HOME VISITOR ☐							
Receive Off Def Pull						Receive Off Def Pull							
Side Q1&2						Side Q1&2							
TEAM						TEAM							
1	2	3	4	5	6	S C O R E	1	2	3	4	5	6	
7	8	9	10	11	12		7	8	9	10	11	12	
13	14	15	16	17	18		13	14	15	16	17	18	
19	20	21	22	23	24		19	20	21	22	23	24	
25	26	27	28	29	30		25	26	27	28	29	30	
1st Half		2nd Half		OT1 OT2		T O	1st Half		2nd Half		OT1 OT2		
Warnings		Penalties		VIOLATIONS		Warnings		Penalties		VIOLATIONS			
				Technical						Technical			
				TMF						TMF			
Player #		1st / When		2nd / When		M I S C O N D U C T	Player #		1st / When		2nd / When		
CAPTAINS						CAPTAINS							
OBSERVER NAMES						Game Date:						Misconduct Categories	
						Location:						1. Dangerous Play 2. Intentional Infraction 3. Repeated Infraction 4. Unsporting Behavior 5. Other	
						Start Time:							

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				Technical						Technical			
				TMF						TMF			
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19	20	21	22	23	24		19	20	21	22	23	24	
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